



Living Savior Lutheran Church and Preschool

5500 Ox Road
Fairfax Station, Virginia, 22039
Church office: 703-352-1421
Preschool office: 703-352-4208
secretary@livingsaviorlutheran.org

April 1, 2020

Dear Friends,

I pray that this correspondence finds you all well and coping as best you can in the midst of the Coronavirus pandemic. When I last wrote you on March 17th, I informed you that we will close in-church worship and meetings until April 1st. As I'm sure most of you have seen, yesterday the Virginia Governor Issued Executive Order Fifty-Five (attached) mandating stay at home, which will require Living Savior Lutheran Church to remain closed to in-building worship services and other activities that exceed 10 people until June 10, 2020.

Living Savior has really shown a resilience during this crisis and as such, we will continue to tape our services and post them on Facebook and our Webpage along with bulletins. Pastor Andy, Vicar Brad, Dr. Horton, Dr. Benson, Sid & Tim Heetland, Dave Huxsoll, and Habtu Mesfen are really doing a great job conducting the services and adding them to our Website and Facebook pages. Special thanks to Pastor Andy for his tireless efforts to keep worship, Bible Study, and fellowship active during this crisis. He has really put in overtime to keep things going – thank you so much Andy!

God is amazing and we continue to operate despite our current constraints and we are finding new ways to reach out to each other.

Here are some examples of ministries that continue to function in the age of “stay at home” orders.

Social Ministry Calling Tree: Steve and Bonnie Thomas have started a calling tree whereby all members of the church will receive a call from various lay leaders. In addition to congregation members calling each other, Pastor Andy is also calling families to check up on them during this pandemic.

Meetings: In-Building meetings remain off limits; however, meetings continue to occur using Zoom and other teleworking platforms. Examples of meetings being held this way include the quarterly property meeting, finance committee meeting, BOSL/ML meetings, and the men's group Bible Study. Meetings are being transitioned to this new meeting format and I encourage others to hold a teleconference instead of cancelling meetings (e.g., Bible Studies, group meetings).

Giving: Paul Gross provided a great call to continue giving last week where he discussed the different ways to give in his letter to the congregation. During this very difficult time, we are adding new ways to give, including credit/debit card transaction. I encourage you to consider giving electronically and continue giving any way possible so we can continue to pay our bills and meet our on-going obligations. The Finance team is also looking at applying for CARE Act payroll benefits and other stimulus loans to help offset our mounting income losses.

Church Staff: Teresa, Susana, and Liz continue to come in to the church daily to keep operations going. Susana is doing more outside work as she catches up on cleaning the inside of the building. Examples of this work include weeding, raking leaves, and cleaning the preschool playground and patio area.

Education: Leon has been sharing lesson plans offered on line by Concordia Publishing and conducted an audit of all families with school aged children. He is reaching out to not only current Sunday School Students, but also to those who have not participated in the program this year. If you wish to participate in these at home programs, please contact Leon DeBolt.

Preschool: Preschool Teachers have provided lesson plans for students and are reviewing options to conduct on line age appropriate learning.

The Board of Servant Leaders (BOSL) will be meeting via Zoom next week to discuss the current situation and church operations and BOSL will also join the Ministry Leads via Zoom at their regular meeting on April 14th to discuss the upcoming 2020-21 church and preschool budgets.

I wish you and your family safe passage through this very difficult time and pray for your continued strength and good health.

Blessings,

Chuck Froemke

President, LSLC BOSL